

**BEFORE THE PUBLIC UTILITIES COMMISSION
OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA**



FILED

11/17/25

04:59 PM

R2312008

Order Instituting Rulemaking
Regarding Transportation
Electrification Policy and
Infrastructure.

Rulemaking 23-12-008
(Filed December 14, 2023)

**COMMENTS OF THE VEHICLE-GRID INTEGRATION COUNCIL ON THE
PROPOSED DECISION ADOPTING REVISED DATA GATHERING AND
REPORTING REQUIREMENTS FOR TRANSPORTATION ELECTRIFICATION
PROGRAMS AND PROVIDING CLARIFICATION ON PROGRAMS ADOPTED IN
DECISION 22-11-040**

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Date: November 17, 2025

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DECISION 22-11-040**

In accordance with the Rules of Practice and Procedure of the California Public Utilities Commission (“Commission”), the Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (“VGIC”) hereby submits these comments on the *Proposed Decision Adopting Revised Data Gathering and Reporting Requirements for Transportation Electrification Programs and Providing Clarification on Programs Adopted in Decision 22-11-040* issued by President Alice Reynolds on October 27, 2025.

I. INTRODUCTION.

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to comment on the future of ratepayer transportation electrification (TE) funding and reporting. These issues are critical, as transportation electrification and vehicle-grid integration (VGI) deliver significant ratepayer benefits. The Public Advocates Office’s 2025 Distribution Grid Electrification Model (DGEM 2025) finds that widespread managed charging of EVs could save up to \$18 billion in distribution grid upgrade costs by 2040, while also exerting downward pressure on rates of up to 4.5 cents per kWh across the state’s

investor-owned utilities (IOUs).¹ Similarly, Pacific Gas and Electric's (PG&E) Electrification Impact Study (EIS) Part 2 concludes that electrification growth may reduce distribution rates by as much as 25 percent by 2040, driven by increased electricity sales that spread fixed grid costs across a larger customer base and but also by the deployment of demand-flexibility strategies such as dynamic pricing, active managed charging, and bidirectional EV capabilities.²

These findings reinforce the importance of proactive TE and VGI investments authorized by the Commission. Therefore, in response to the PD, VGIC offers the following comments:

- The Commission should make a determination to move forward with Funding Cycle 1
- VGIC supports the removal of vehicle purchasing requirements from Funding Cycle 0 (FC0) Make-Ready programs and other barriers should be removed
- FC0 Funds should remain in place until exhausted
- Specific questions on VGI data should be preserved in reporting

II. THE COMMISSION SHOULD MAKE A DETERMINATION TO MOVE FORWARD WITH FUNDING CYCLE 1.

VGIC is disappointed that the PD continues the pause of FC1 indefinitely without discussing the merits of the behind-the-meter (BTM) rebate program or the clear need for sustained funding to support transportation electrification. As drafted, the PD sends a signal that the Commission does not plan to support transportation electrification funding for the foreseeable future, especially given that it sets no timeline for revisiting FC1. The Commission should reverse this signal by authorizing FC1 to move forward or, at a minimum, establishing a clear schedule in this decision for when FC1 will be reconsidered.

¹ Cal Advocates, Distribution Grid Electrification Model 2025 Study and Report, October 2025 at p.85. <https://www.publicadvocates.cpuc.ca.gov/press-room/reports-and-analyses/distribution-grid-electrification-model-2025>

² *Pacific Gas and Electric Company's (U 39 E) Draft Electrification Impact Study Part 2*, October 31, 2025, filed in Rulemaking 21-06-017 at p.13.

VGIC continues to view FC1 as an essential program for customers seeking funding to support electrification. VGIC previously stated in July 2024 that “Without the TE Rebate Program, the Commission risks slowing down EV adoption and, in turn, directly jeopardizes California’s TE and broader decarbonization goals.”³ This concern is even more urgent today. Since 2024, the federal EV tax credit has sunset, and the California Air Resources Board (CARB) has lost key waivers for the Advanced Clean Cars, Advanced Clean Trucks, and Advanced Clean Fleets regulations. With higher upfront costs and fewer regulatory drivers accelerating vehicle transitions, California will need to provide clear, durable incentives to maintain momentum on transportation electrification.

Authorizing FC1 or identifying a firm timeline for its reconsideration is therefore critical to sustaining California’s TE progress and ensuring that customers have access to near-term funding tools necessary to electrify. VGIC urges the Commission to make such a determination in this decision.

III. VGIC SUPPORTS THE REMOVAL OF VEHICLE PURCHASING REQUIREMENTS FROM FUNDING CYCLE 0 MAKE-READY PROGRAMS AND OTHER BARRIERS SHOULD BE REMOVED.

Given the ongoing pause of FC1, it is increasingly important that the Commission ensure existing programs operate efficiently and without unnecessary constraints. VGIC therefore supports removing vehicle purchasing requirements from the FC0 programs. As discussed by the Commission, new business models, such as charging-as-a-service model, are making it more common for multiple fleets to use the same sites and for charging site developers to not be the fleet

³ VGIC Comments on Track 1 Ruling at 3.

vehicle purchasers.⁴ Removing this barrier will help ease the development of charging sites and can allow more funds to be utilized to develop chargers that would otherwise not be deployed.

In addition to removing vehicle-purchase requirements, VGIC urges the Commission to address other FC0 program design barriers that have constrained participation. One significant barrier has been limiting customers to participating in FC0 or Make-Ready programs only once. This penalizes early adopters who install a small amount of EVSE initially as a pilot before scaling to full fleet electrification. For example, many school districts installed a small number of electric school buses and chargers under FC0 to test operations. Once ready to proceed with full-fleet electrification, they were ineligible for further FC0 support and were instead required to use the IOUs' EV Infrastructure Rules 29/45. There has been significant participation in these rules, with San Diego Gas and Electric (SDG&E) having to pause acceptance of Rule 45 applications when they reached a previously allocated cost cap.⁵ By not allowing customers to participate in these programs more than once, the Commission has excluded many of the customers who are most likely and best prepared at this point to engage with the existing make ready programs. Allowing prior participants to re-apply could meaningfully increase program engagement.

IV. FUNDING CYCLE 0 FUNDS SHOULD REMAIN IN PLACE UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

Because the PD proposes to continue the pause of FC1 with no timeline for reconsideration, it is essential that FC0 funding remain available until fully exhausted. The PD declines to extend the FC0 funding for EV infrastructure past 2026, stating that these funds are not sufficiently used and that other sources of funding outside of ratepayer funds can be used to support infrastructure

⁴ PD at 15.

⁵ SDG&E Advice Letter 4705-E.

investments past 2026. As discussed above, FC0 participation has been limited not because demand is lacking, but because several program design barriers have inhibited customer access. Removing the vehicle-purchase requirement, eliminating the one-time participation barrier, and addressing other barriers would substantially increase interest in FC0 programs.

The PD also cites the California Energy Commission's (CEC) Energy Infrastructure Incentives for Zero-Emission Commercial Vehicles (EnergyIZE Commercial Vehicles) and California Electric Vehicle Infrastructure Project (CALeVIP), and the federal government's National Electric Vehicle Infrastructure (NEVI) Program as alternative funding sources. However, these funds have experienced significant fluctuations, and it is unclear whether all of these programs will have sufficient funding to meet demand after 2026. NEVI funding has currently been restored to states, but the federal administration has previously frozen the release of these funds, and it is unclear whether future changes to federal funding are on the horizon. California has shown a stronger commitment to the deployment of EV chargers compared to the federal government, but state funding has also fluctuated over the years due to changes in the state budget. California has faced general budgetary challenges in recent years. The CEC's Transportation Program has \$100 million in consistent funding, but supplemental funding from the Cap-and-Invest funded Greenhouse Gas Reduction Fund (GGRF) has seen large fluctuations. There is also desire for this funding to be used for other clean transportation efforts, such as providing vehicle incentives for low-income drivers, and other climate initiatives. Particularly when considering increasing holes from federal funding, it is hard to rely on the state budget to fill all gaps in future fiscal years.

By maintaining FC0 funding past 2026 and until fully exhausted and by addressing key program barriers, the Commission can ensure continuity in transportation electrification support

during the pause of FC1, allow continued scaling of EV deployments, and maximize the value of funds already authorized. This approach provides the most stable and reasonable path forward while longer-term funding questions remain unresolved.

V. SPECIFIC QUESTIONS ON VGI DATA SHOULD BE PRESERVED IN REPORTING.

VGIC believes the VGI section of the comprehensive annual report should continue to have specific questions for the utilities to respond to. The value of the VGI reporting is to get a comprehensive view and specific data on the utilities' VGI efforts. In particular, VGIC has seen immense value in learning about the enrollment in the specific rates, pilots, and programs being administered by each of the IOUs. These are the most valuable components of utility VGI reporting, as they can critically inform policy decisions. In some cases, VGIC urges the utilities to issue more detailed responses. For example, questions 25 and 26 ask the utilities to report on the capacity of EVs enrolled in demand response programs and their load shift / energy potential. In the most recent 2025 VGI Mid-term Reports, SDG&E answers these questions by noting that "VGI enrollment in ELRP A.5 has remained low within SDG&E's service territory."⁶ SCE discusses enrollment capacity (MW) for ELRP Group A.1, which includes EVs, but does not share any enrollment capacity figures for ELRP Group A.5, despite sharing that "ELRP Sub-Group A.5. has 72 active participants as of June 30, 2025."⁷ PG&E provides the most comprehensive data, sharing that they expect "2 MW of incremental load reduction per hour during events"⁸ in 2025.

The load profile data reported by the utilities is also extremely useful, and the Commission should take learnings from these load profiles into future rate design and program development.

⁶ SDG&E Vehicle-Grid Integration Activities Midterm Report For 2025 at p.A-13.

⁷ SCE Mid-Term Report on Vehicle-Grid Integration Strategies, Programs and Pilots Metrics at p.A-27.

⁸ PG&E Mid-Term Vehicle-Grid Integration Strategies Report for September 2025 at p.20.

There is already significant evidence that EV load profiles can increase or avoid distribution grid upgrades and other grid costs, with Cal Advocates recently estimating that EV load management can save up to **\$18 billion** in grid upgrade costs through 2040.⁹ This aspect of reporting is helpful, as it reveals the real-world evidence of successfully shifting charging load away from peak periods.

Given the inconsistencies in current IOU reporting and the value of accurate data, it is worthwhile to revisit the reporting templates and ensure that the data shared by the utilities is useful by consolidating to specific questions seeking specific data points, rather than questions that allow utilities to issue high-level, narrative responses. VGIC looks forward to working with the utilities, Energy Division, and other stakeholders at the 2026 VGI Forum to enhance reporting practices. The Commission must require reporting that sufficiently informs future learnings. Prudent policy and investment decisions should be supported by this reporting, rather than anecdotal evidence alone.

VI. CONCLUSION.

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to provide these comments. We look forward to further collaboration with the Commission and stakeholders on this initiative.

Respectfully submitted,
/s/ Zach Woogen
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VEHICLE-GRID INTEGRATION COUNCIL

Date: November 17, 2025

⁹ Cal Advocates, Distribution Grid Electrification Model 2025 Study and Report, October 2025 at p.85. <https://www.publicadvocates.cpuc.ca.gov/press-room/reports-and-analyses/distribution-grid-electrification-model-2025>